

VIJO JOHN

F&A, Fund Accounting & Financial Reporting Platforms · BFSI · Enterprise AI Strategy

vjohn1111@gmail.com · +91-9891240426 · linkedin.com/in/vijojohn · github.com/VijoJohn

India · Open to roles across Digital Finance, Banking & Capital Markets, and Enterprise AI Strategy

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

AI transformation leader and Finance domain expert. 20+ years across global financial services (State Street, HSBC, Ameriprise) — deep in **fund accounting & financial reporting for mutual funds, capital markets, and complex financial products** — now VP, Head of Finance, **leading enterprise AI enablement and digital-finance transformation** across the F&A function. Owns the agenda end-to-end — AI opportunity portfolio, build-vs-buy, responsible-AI governance, and adoption — while staying hands-on enough to **prototype agentic workflows (LangGraph, RAG, evaluation harnesses)** across **fund accounting & financial reporting for investment funds, accounts payable, order-to-cash (O2C), and record-to-report (R2R)**, so strategy stays grounded in what actually ships. IIM Kozhikode MBA (Strategy & Finance), Six Sigma Black Belt, ex-CISO with six consecutive years of zero material ITGC / SOC1 findings — rare combination of **transformation leadership, regulated-domain credibility, and hands-on technical fluency**.

SELECTED IMPACT

Led the build of AI Finance OS — an autonomous finance operating layer with LangGraph agents (bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, reconciliation) and CFO decision dashboards; set the vision, scoped the MVP, and drove it to a working prototype.

Delivered 5 finance & enterprise AI prototypes — NAV-break investigation & voice co-pilot, SOI review, and an enterprise ethics advisor — each with an offline eval harness (golden datasets, groundedness, LLM-as-judge).

Drove ~USD 200K annualized savings, +40% productivity, and ~80% reporting-prep time as Head of Finance, via process restructuring, vendor / SaaS optimization, and automation.

AI PRODUCT MANAGEMENT

Discovery & Definition	Problem framing for F&A platforms (fund accounting & financial reporting for investment funds, AP / O2C / R2R) · user research with finance / ops stakeholders · jobs-to-be-done · PRDs · user stories · acceptance criteria
Roadmap & Prioritization	Use-case portfolio scoring · RICE / impact-effort · OKRs & KPI trees · release planning · stakeholder alignment across CFO / CTO / audit
LLM Product Patterns	Agentic workflows · RAG-grounded assistants · human-in-the-loop · prompt routing · cost / latency tradeoffs · fallback design · model selection (Azure OpenAI, Groq, Llama)
Evaluation & Quality	Offline evaluation harnesses · golden datasets · LLM-as-judge · groundedness & hallucination checks · prompt / model comparison · eval logging & telemetry

ENTERPRISE AI STRATEGY

Opportunity Portfolio	AI use-case discovery & qualification · value-at-stake sizing · ROI cases · sequencing under capacity constraints · CFO / board-ready business cases
Build vs Buy vs Partner	Vendor evaluation (Azure OpenAI, Qdrant, SaaS) · platform vs point-solution · vertical integration calls · TCO modeling
Operating Model	Center-of-excellence design · AI guild patterns · skills mapping · change management · adoption & enablement playbooks
Responsible AI & Governance	Human-in-the-loop controls · auditability · model risk · data privacy by design · enterprise AI policy · ISO 27001 / SOC1 alignment

TECHNICAL FLUENCY

Hands-On Stack	LangGraph multi-agent orchestration · RAG & vector search (Qdrant, embeddings, semantic retrieval) · Azure OpenAI / Groq / Llama · evaluation harnesses & groundedness checks · Python / FastAPI / SQL — fluent enough to prototype, spec, and pressure-test what engineering ships
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ENTERPRISE DOMAIN DEPTH — FINANCE & CONTROLS

Finance Function Ownership	Accounts payable (AP / P2P) · order-to-cash (O2C) · record-to-report (R2R) · intercompany accounting & reconciliation · invoicing, billing & export invoicing · AR, collections & DSO · month / quarter / annual book closure · budgetary controls & earnout calculation · MIS & leadership reporting
Compliance & Controls	GST · TDS · India payroll · FEMA · MCA / ROC compliance · US GAAP & Ind AS · ITGC / SOC1 audit readiness · internal controls · governance frameworks · ISO 27001 · CISO experience
Systems & Tooling	advanced MS Excel & Power Query · ERP / accounting platforms · finance process automation

AI PRODUCTS — CONCEIVED, DESIGNED & DELIVERED

AI Finance OS FLAGSHIP *Python · FastAPI · LangGraph · PostgreSQL · Streamlit*

Working prototype of an autonomous finance operating layer with LangGraph-orchestrated agents for bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, and reconciliation workflows, plus CFO decision dashboards. Owned the user journeys, scoped the MVP, chose the architecture, and built the system end-to-end.

NAV Break Investigation Agent *LangGraph · Azure OpenAI · Qdrant RAG*

Detection → Investigation → Reflection agent loop grounded by a RAG layer over NAV validation rules and investigation playbooks; prompt routing, logging, and an offline evaluation harness. Targets the real exception-management workflow fund accounting teams run every day.

NAV Break Voice Co-pilot *LiveKit voice / avatar · grounded tools · audit trail · guardrails*

Real-time voice / avatar co-pilot for the daily NAV-striking window — analysts query breaks hands-free (“walk me through break 4827, cite the source”) while watching the dashboard. Tool-grounded answers, full JSONL audit trail per token / tool / resolution, and a confirm-resolution guardrail; built on mock NAV records and designed to plug into the live NAV Break Investigation Agent.

SOI Review Agent *8-agent pipeline · PDF extraction · ASC 946 RAG · preventive controls*

Eight-agent pipeline automating Schedule of Investments review under US GAAP ASC 946 — PDF extraction, SOI detection, structured-data building, specialized validation, prior-cycle comparison, and a preventive-control agent grounded by an ASC 946 RAG knowledge base.

Enterprise Ethics Advisor *Multimodal RAG · CLIP · fully local*

Fully local multimodal RAG for corporate ethics guidance; CLIP retrieves policy diagrams and text together — governed AI advisory with zero external data exposure. Built for regulated environments.

LEADERSHIP & TRANSFORMATION IMPACT

- 60+ clients migrated to a new platform with 50% fewer support tickets.
- New US subsidiary incorporated as a direct arm of the parent — simplified the operating model and enabled scalable cross-border operations.
- Book closure BD10 → BD8 and MIS reporting accelerated by 2 days.
- CISO & ISO 27001 certified; established SOC readiness through control-framework design.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

McLaren Strategic Solutions — Vice President, Head of Finance

Jun 2025 – Present

- Lead AI-led digital-finance transformation across F&A platforms — own the AI use-case portfolio and build-vs-buy decisions, direct delivery, and stay hands-on enough to prototype agentic workflows spanning accounts payable, order-to-cash, reconciliation, reporting, and controls.
- Run the finance function end-to-end as the design partner for the AI products — accounts payable (AP), order-to-cash (O2C), record-to-report (R2R), book closure (month / quarter / annual), export invoicing, budgetary controls, earnout calculations, and presales support — across India and the US.
- Lead statutory & regulatory compliance for India operations — GST, TDS, India payroll, FEMA, and MCA / ROC filings — alongside US GAAP / Ind AS reporting and audit readiness.
- Partner with senior leadership on AI strategy, governance, and roadmap; serve as bridge between business stakeholders, engineering, and audit.

State Street, Bangalore — Sr. AVP / AVP / Sr. Manager, Financial Reporting

Jul 2018 – Jun 2025

Progressive growth: Sr. Manager (2018) → AVP (2020) → Senior AVP (2023) · Financial Reporting & Arc Reporting Product Owner

- Product Owner for the Arc financial-reporting platform — owned the requirements backlog and stakeholder priorities, partnering with technology to drive reporting automation, data integrity, and on-time regulatory delivery; an early grounding in the product discipline I now apply to AI.
- Built, led, and developed multi-tier reporting teams (analysts to managers) delivering US GAAP-compliant financial statements and reconciliations on schedule — scaled talent, set performance benchmarks, and instilled a culture of operational excellence, client satisfaction, and retention.
- Led strategic-initiative evaluation and prioritization across the reporting function, aligning delivery with business objectives and strengthening executive decision-making.
- Oversaw ITGC and SOC1 audits with a record of zero material findings; accountable for reporting systems and data-feed integrity — direct relevance to enterprise AI governance and model risk.
- Managed post-M&A cross-functional integration (e.g., Syntel, HCL JVs); led P&L optimization and process re-engineering.

HSBC EDPI, Gurgaon — Manager, Business Finance

Dec 2016 – Jul 2018

- Finance business partner for global operations — strategic insights, annual operating plans, budgeting, forecasting, and variance analysis to guide business and operational decisions.
- Owned intercompany charging, recovery, and reconciliation — designed cost-recovery strategies and intercompany reporting across business units, ensuring accurate cross-entity allocation and clean, audit-ready reconciliations.
- Delivered executive reporting solutions — Flash reports, standardised reporting packs, and CFO-level financial models for senior-leadership presentations.
- Engineered advanced data consolidation and reporting tools (Excel, Power Query), streamlining cross-functional reporting and improving accuracy and timeliness.

Ameriprise, Gurgaon — Trainer → Group Leader, Financial Reporting & Tax

Oct 2010 – Dec 2016

- Grew from Fund Accounting trainer to Group Leader across financial reporting and tax, building deep accounting and reconciliation foundations.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MBA (EPGP), Strategy & Finance — Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Kozhikode · 2023

Certifications: Six Sigma Black Belt · ISO 27001 Implementer · ISO 9001 Implementer · Leader as a Coach

Domains: Capital Markets & Fund Administration · Banking · Insurance · IT — US GAAP & Indian Accounting (Ind AS)

RECENT AI PRODUCT ADDENDUM

FP&A Narrative Reporting Copilot (Private GitHub Repository)

FP&A | Narrative Reporting | Variance Commentary | CFO Reviews | MIS Packs | Management Reporting

Private copilot for FP&A narrative reporting that converts financial performance data, variance drivers, and management-reporting context into executive-ready commentary for CFO reviews, MIS packs, and business performance discussions.

Role / contribution:

- ? Conceived and positioned the project as the newest AI finance product in the portfolio.
- ? Applies finance-domain judgment to FP&A commentary, variance narratives, and management reporting.
- ? Extends the AI product portfolio beyond fund administration and controls into CFO decision support.

Repository: github.com/VijoJohn/FPnA_Narrative_Reporting_Copilot (private as of June 2026)

Portfolio alignment

This addendum keeps the downloadable resume aligned with the portfolio while preserving text extraction for ATS parsing.